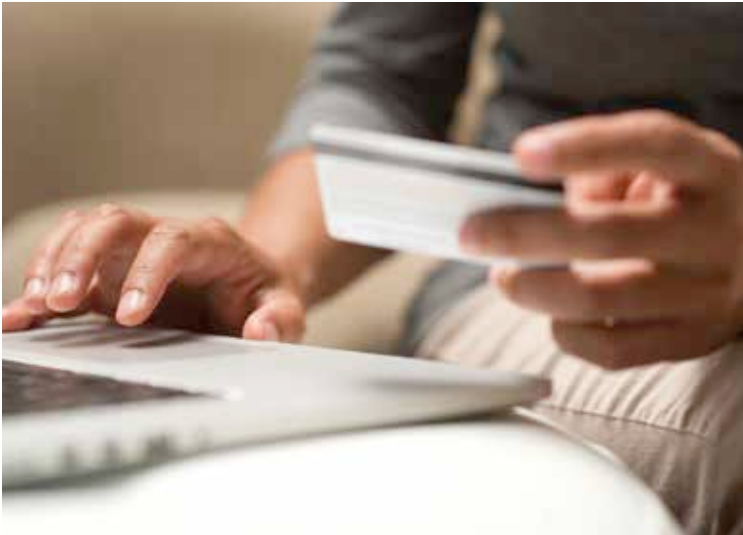


No free lunch (?)

The full version of Adobe Acrobat DC – the de facto standard used to create, edit, export and share PDF documents – comes at a hefty price of ₹9708 per year. And that's just the Standard version. Meanwhile, if you need to retouch your vacation photos so your nasty shaving cut doesn't show, Photoshop is about to set you back by ₹12,000 per year. Oh, and is your monthly sales report and presentation due next Monday? You're about to shell out ₹4,199 per for Microsoft Hone Office 365.

Proprietary software is so popular and all-encompassing today that for most people, it's quite simply a standard by which they often blindly abide. Brand names implicitly convey a sense of trust and reliability, while



Proprietary software can be expensive, but that isn't your only option

the expansive checklists boasting of dozens of features certainly look impressive – even though, deep down, we all know we're never going to use most of them.

Now, you could spend all this money to buy proprietary software, bask in its glory and then spend the rest of the year desperately searching for excuses to use those applications. Or, you could just download LibreOffice and GIMP (GNU Image Manipulation Program) – both of which are free and open source – and get the job done for free.